

Welcome to ECON0117: Seminar 1

How ECON0117 is assessed

20%

Research proposal

Your research plan. The first summative assessment, due in January.

60%

Dissertation

The written dissertation itself.

20%

Viva voce

An oral exam where you show your understanding, judgement and ownership of your research.

OPTIONAL **Explore Econ 2027** · Conference, third week of May 2026 · Submit by March/April

Continuous engagement is one of your marking criteria

Continuous engagement is one of your marking criteria



I follow your research journey

Week by week, I see how your ideas and your research develop.

Continuous engagement is one of your marking criteria



I follow your research journey

Week by week, I see how your ideas and your research develop.



You use AI responsibly

Regular discussion of your work shows how you use AI tools.

Continuous engagement is one of your marking criteria



I follow your research journey

Week by week, I see how your ideas and your research develop.



You use AI responsibly

Regular discussion of your work shows how you use AI tools.



Your work keeps its integrity

Seeing your progress first-hand confirms the work is your own.

	Date	Agenda	Homework
Seminar 1	12 Oct	Pick your research topic	
Office Hours (Zoom)	19 Oct		
Seminar 2	26 Oct	Finalise your topic	Homework 2: Your research question & the literature behind it (Deadline: 21 Oct, 17:00)
Office Hours (Zoom)	2 Nov		
Seminar 3	16 Nov	Working on your draft question	Literature review of your topic
Seminar 4	30 Nov	Working on your research proposal	TBC
Office Hours (Zoom)	7 Dec		
Seminar 5	14 Dec	Working on your research proposal	Draft of your proposal

Office hours on Zoom Meeting ID: 912 8312 0205 Passcode: 915665

Your research builds on the literature



Grounded in the literature

Position your question within what is already known about your topic.

Extends what we know

Add something the literature does not yet cover: new data, a new context or a new angle.

Term 1:



Term 2:



HOMEWORK 1

Let’s discuss what you found in the broader literature

HOMEWORK 1

Now let’s turn to your research questions

What kinds of questions do economists ask?

EMPIRICAL QUESTIONS

> ### What is the effect of A on B?
> How large is the effect, and in which direction does it go?

What kinds of questions do economists ask?

EMPIRICAL QUESTIONS

> **What is the effect of A on B?**
> How large is the effect, and in which direction does it go?

EXAMPLES

1. What is the impact of natural resource wealth on democracy?

2. What was the impact of South Korea's industrial policy (the HCI Drive) in the 1970s on manufacturing growth?

Worked example: South Korea’s industrial policy

1 Question
2 Theory
3 Empirics

What was the impact of South Korea’s industrial policy (the HCI Drive) in the 1970s on manufacturing growth?

Worked example: South Korea’s industrial policy

What was the impact of South Korea’s industrial policy (the HCI Drive) in the 1970s on manufacturing growth?

A · THE POLICY

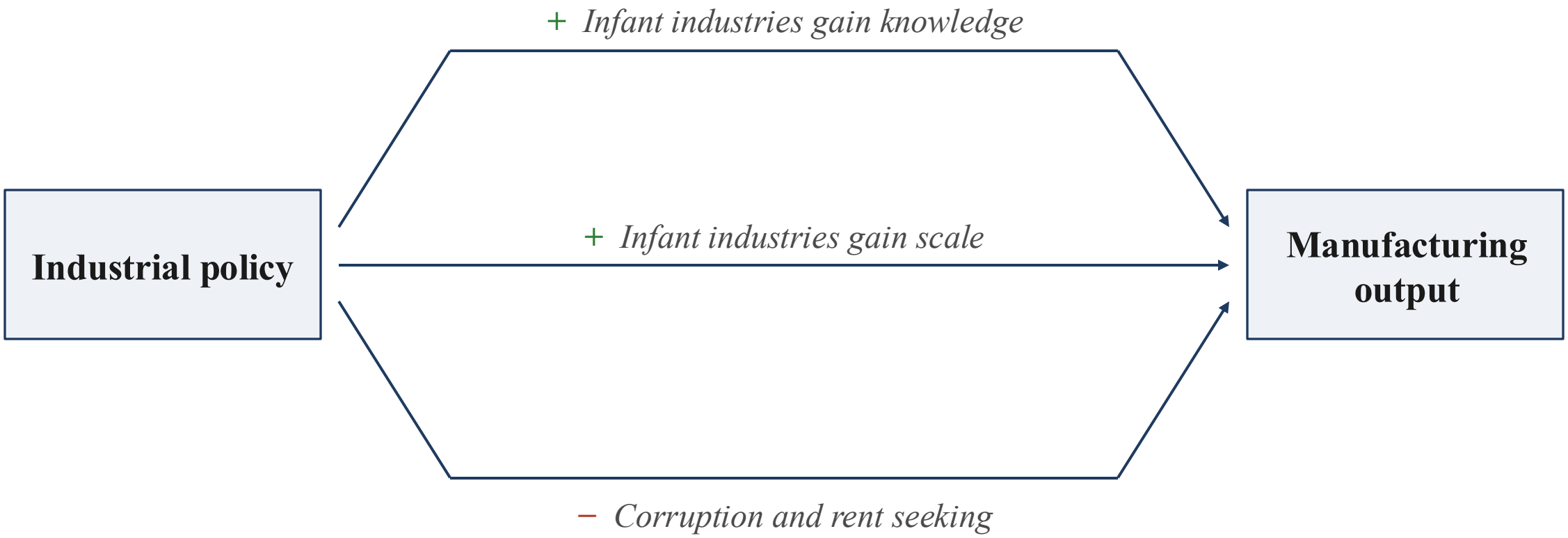
The HCI Drive: state support for heavy and chemical industries

effect? →

B · THE OUTCOME

Manufacturing output and growth

Theory: the policy could raise or lower output



Empirics: targeted industries outgrew the rest

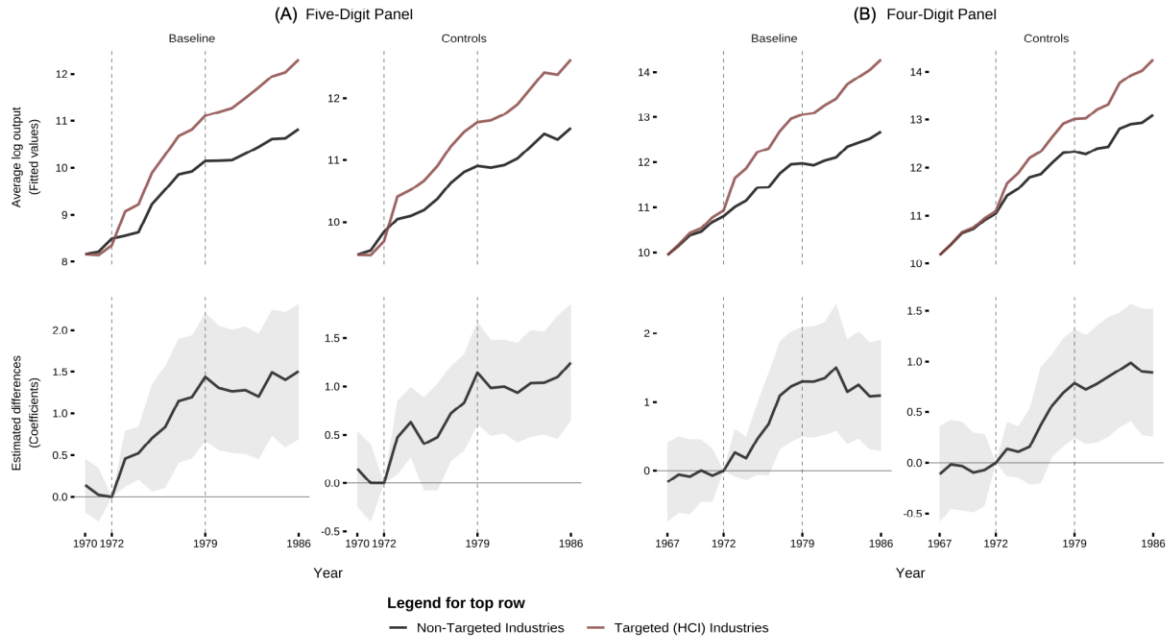


FIGURE II

Industrial Policy and Industry Output

TOP ROW

Output of HCI-targeted industries (red) against non-targeted industries (black)

BOTTOM ROW

Estimated gap between the two groups, which widens after the policy starts in 1973

Source: Lane, N. (2025), "Manufacturing Revolutions: Industrial Policy and Industrialization in South Korea," Quarterly Journal of Economics 140(3), Figure II.

What kinds of questions do economists ask?

HISTORICAL QUESTIONS

> **Why did B happen?**
> Which factors (A, X, Y, Z) contributed to the emergence of B?

What kinds of questions do economists ask?

HISTORICAL QUESTIONS

> **Why did B happen?**
> Which factors (A, X, Y, Z) contributed to the emergence of B?

EXAMPLES

1 Why did India’s political elite abandon trade protectionism in 1991?

2 What was the primary cause of Thailand’s 1997 financial crisis?

Your research question:

All responses to your question will be shown here

Each response can be up to 200 characters long

Turn on voting to let participants vote for their favorites

Responding is off

Do Homework 2